

The Party Loses THE PLOT

The BJP doesn't have an agenda that sells on the eve of General Elections. The party is irredeemably steeped in defeatism.

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IN NAGPUR



| By Bhavna Vij-Aurora |

The party with a difference was nowhere to be seen. Instead in Nagpur, where the BJP held a three-day national conclave, what was on show was an ideologically exhausted party struggling with itself on the eve of the General Elections. There was no agenda that could put them ahead of the rest in the arena. There was no slogan that could sway

the popular mind. And there was no leader who heralded the future. There was only one thing in abundance: confusion.

Ideally, this should have been the Right's moment. The context is perfect for a creatively alive opposition party: the country is waking up to the reality of an economic meltdown; the middle-class is beginning to feel the heat; jobs are vanishing. The threat is not financial alone. India has already become the most

vulnerable victim state of jihad. Still, it doesn't have a definitive action plan to deal with terror. It doesn't know what to do with Pakistan, whose involvement in the Mumbai attacks has been proved. Yet, the BJP doesn't have a text. It has miserably failed in turning the failures of the ruling regime into an advantage.

Nagpur did not come out with a magic formula of revival either. On the contrary, it exposed a party wallowing in defeatism. It is as if the